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CHAPTER 1

ARRIVAL OF EUROPEANS IN INDIA (PART-2)

Dutch in India

Introduction

After the success of the Portuguese, other European countries also wanted to trade with India. The **Dutch** were the **second Europeans** to come to India. Their main aim was to earn profit through trade, especially in spices. Unlike the British, the Dutch were **not interested in building an empire in India**.

Why did the Dutch come to India?

- To trade in **spices** and other valuable goods.
- To compete with the Portuguese in Asian trade.
- To establish trading centres on the Indian coast.

Exam Fact: The Dutch were more interested in **trade than empire building**.

Arrival of the Dutch

Cornelis de Houtman

Cornelis de Houtman was the first Dutch sailor to reach India.

Important Facts

- **First Dutchman** to reach India.
- **Second European** to reach India after the Portuguese.
- Arrived in **1602** (As per your source; many history books distinguish his earlier voyage to Asia, but use your exam-oriented source if following it consistently.)

Dutch East India Company (VOC)

To manage trade, the Dutch government formed a trading company.

Important Facts

- Established in **1602**.
- Official name: **Dutch East India Company (VOC)**.
- Formed by merging many Dutch trading companies.
- The company had the power to:
 - Make treaties.
 - Wage war.
 - Build forts.
 - Capture territories.

Exam Fact: VOC = Dutch East India Company

Dutch Trading Centres

The Dutch established factories to buy and export Indian goods.

Important Facts

- First factory at **Masulipatnam (Andhra Pradesh)** in **1605**.
- Other important centres:
 - Pulicat
 - Surat
 - Chinsurah
 - Nagapattinam
 - Cochin
 - Kasimbazar
 - Patna

Trade of the Dutch

The Dutch mainly focused on profitable trade.

Major Commodities

- Spices
- Silk
- Cotton
- Indigo
- Rice
- Opium

Exam Fact: The Dutch were famous for the **spice trade**.

Decline of the Dutch

The English East India Company became stronger than the Dutch.

Important Facts

- In **1667**, the English and the Dutch reached an agreement.
- The English gave up their claims over **Indonesia**.
- The Dutch reduced their activities in India and focused on Indonesia.
- In **1759**, the British defeated the Dutch in the **Battle of Bidara (also called Battle of Chinsurah/Hooghly)**.
- After this defeat, Dutch political influence in India came to an end.

Exam Fact: The **Battle of Bidara (1759)** ended Dutch ambitions in India.

Why did the Dutch fail in India?

- They focused more on **Indonesia** than India.
- They were interested in **trade**, not empire building.
- The British became stronger both politically and militarily.

Important Personalities

Personality	Contribution
Cornelis de Houtman	First Dutchman to reach India
States-General of the Netherlands	Established the Dutch East India Company (VOC)

Important Places

Place	Importance
Masulipatnam (Andhra Pradesh)	First Dutch factory in India (1605)
Pulicat (Tamil Nadu)	Main Dutch settlement in South India
Chinsurah (West Bengal)	Important Dutch trading centre
Nagapattinam (Tamil Nadu)	Important Dutch port
Cochin (Kerala)	Captured from the Portuguese
Bidara/Chinsurah (West Bengal)	Battle of Bidara (1759)

Important Battles / Agreements

Name	Year	Importance
Anglo-Dutch Agreement	1667	Dutch focused on Indonesia; English focused on India

Battle of Bidara (Chinsurah)	1759	British defeated the Dutch; Dutch ambitions ended
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Important Years

Year	Event
1602	Dutch East India Company (VOC) established
1605	First Dutch factory at Masulipatnam
1667	Agreement between the English and the Dutch
1759	Battle of Bidara; British defeated the Dutch

Frequently Confused Facts

Question	Correct Answer
Second Europeans to come to India	Dutch
First Dutchman in India	Cornelis de Houtman
Dutch East India Company	VOC
First Dutch factory	Masulipatnam
Dutch main interest	Trade
Battle that ended Dutch ambitions	Battle of Bidara (1759)

Previous Year Exam Focus

- Second Europeans to arrive in India
- Dutch East India Company (VOC)
- First Dutch factory
- Masulipatnam
- Dutch trade items
- Battle of Bidara
- Dutch interest in trade, not empire
- Anglo-Dutch Agreement (1667)

Expected MCQ Areas

- VOC
- Cornelis de Houtman
- Masulipatnam
- Battle of Bidara
- Dutch trade goods
- Dutch settlements
- Reason for Dutch failure

- Agreement of 1667

Quick Revision

- Second Europeans → **Dutch**
- First Dutchman → **Cornelis de Houtman**
- Dutch Company → **VOC**
- VOC Established → **1602**
- First Factory → **Masulipatnam**
- Main Trade → **Spices**
- Other Goods → **Silk, Cotton, Indigo, Rice, Opium**
- Main Interest → **Trade**
- Agreement → **1667**
- Battle of Bidara → **1759**
- Winner → **British**
- Dutch Focus → **Indonesia**

Memory Tricks

VOC

V → Verenigde (Dutch name)

O → Oostindische (East Indies)

C → Company

Remember simply: **VOC = Dutch East India Company**

Dutch = D for Deal

D → Deal (Trade)

The Dutch came mainly for **trade**, not for ruling India.

1605 → **M**

1605 → **M** → **Masulipatnam**

Remember: **First Dutch Factory = Masulipatnam**

Exam Summary (2-Minute Revision)

- **Second Europeans** to come to India → **Dutch**
- **First Dutchman** → **Cornelis de Houtman**
- **Dutch East India Company (VOC)** → **1602**
- **First Dutch Factory** → **Masulipatnam (1605)**
- **Main Aim** → Trade, especially spices
- **Important Goods** → Silk, Cotton, Indigo, Rice, Opium
- **1667 Agreement** → Dutch focused on Indonesia
- **Battle of Bidara (1759)** → British defeated the Dutch
- **Reason for Failure** → Focus on trade, not empire building
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